

Persona

What this tool produces · *A set of documented, visual profiles representing the extremes of your target groups, integrating their rational objectives, emotional drivers, and the specific barriers they face in public spaces.*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Dimensions

Social / User

Spatial

Preparing the workshop · *Persona*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Why this tool matters

Giving a face, a name, and a human voice to cold statistics; forcing decision-makers to look the residents in the eye and address their complex human realities.

Evidence we produce

A set of documented, visual profiles representing the extremes of your target groups, integrating their rational objectives, emotional drivers, and the specific barriers they face in public spaces.

Duration & Material

Duration · 2 weeks of field inquiry, 1 synthesis workshop (3 hours)

Material · Printed persona cards (photos, quotes, characteristics), behavior observation grids

Reference case

Public organizations use personas to encapsulate the extreme needs of different citizen groups, ensuring that public services reflect the diversity of the population. Creating structured personas prevents designing in an administrative vacuum and ensures outcomes reflect complex human realities.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Six to eight personas · extreme profiles

Duration
2 weeks of field inquiry, 1 synthesis workshop
(3 hours)

Method

- 1. Conduct field interviews & ethnographic observations.
- 2. Identify the characteristics that most heavily impact use.
- 3. Pick extremes · guarantee diversity, not averages.
- 4. Build 6–8 fictional characters (name, photo, quote, frustrations).
- 5. Test every project decision through these eyes.

photo

#1

Name

Role · age · district

" Verbatim quote from field interview "

Daily context

where, when, with whom

Goals & needs

what they try to achieve

Frustrations

where the service breaks

Behaviours

observed habits & coping

photo

#2

Name

Role · age · district

" Verbatim quote from field interview "

Daily context

where, when, with whom

Goals & needs

what they try to achieve

Frustrations

where the service breaks

Behaviours

observed habits & coping

photo

#3

Name

Role · age · district

" Verbatim quote from field interview "

Daily context

where, when, with whom

Goals & needs

what they try to achieve

Frustrations

where the service breaks

Behaviours

observed habits & coping

Repeat the card pattern until you reach 6–8 personas covering extreme profiles · not averages.

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.